

Malware, Malicious Software

A generic term used to describe malicious software such as: viruses, trojan horses, malicious active content and others.

Malicious Code

A piece of code designed to damage a system or the data it contains, or to prevent the system from being used in its normal manner.

Master Boot Record, Master Boot Sector, MBR, MBS

The boot sector at the beginning of a hard drive (sector location 0,0,1 in CHS notation) is known as the master boot sector or, more commonly, the master boot record.

Master Boot Record Infector

A virus that infects master boot records.

Middle Infector

Refers to an entry point obscuring (EPO) virus. Due to design considerations in some scanners, some non-EPO viruses are referred to as middle infectors and may require special handling.

Multipartite Virus

A virus that infects two or more different target types is generally referred to as a multipartite virus. Early multipartite viruses infected boot sectors and DOS executables, but more esoteric combinations have been seen.

Mutex

MUTual EXclusion object. Mutex is a program object that allows multiple threads to share the same resource. Any thread that needs the resource must lock the mutex from other threads while it is using the resource.

Memory-Resident Virus

A memory-resident virus stays in memory after it executes and infects other files when certain conditions are met. Non-memory-resident viruses are active only while an infected application runs.